Printable Skat rules

Cards and card points

Three players, **32 cards** (♣ ♠ ♥ ♦, each 7 to Ace). Everyone gets ten cards; two lie face down in the middle as the **skat**. The deck holds **120 card points**:

Card	A	10	K	D	B	7	8	9
Card points	11	10	4	3	2	0	0	0

Trumps and following suit

B = J (Bube = Jack) and **D = Q** (Dame = Queen); K and A are the same as in an international deck.

The four **Buben** are always the highest trumps: ♣B, ♠B, ♥B, ♦B. In a suit game the trump suit follows with A, 10, K, D, 9, 8, 7 – eleven trumps. In Grand only the Buben are trumps.

Side suits run A, 10, K, D, 9, 8, 7. Null has no trumps, and every suit runs A, K, D, B, 10, 9, 8, 7.

You must **follow** the suit led; trumps count as one suit, so a Bube follows trumps. If you cannot follow, you may trump or throw off. The highest trump wins the trick, otherwise the highest card of the suit led.

Bidding

Forehand sits on the dealer's left, then middlehand; the dealer is rearhand. **Middlehand bids to forehand** ("yes" or "pass"), then **rearhand bids to the winner**. Whoever is left is the declarer, and their game must reach the last bid. If all pass, the cards are dealt again. Only these values may be bid:

Every value you can bid, from the lowest up

18, 20, 22, 23, 24, 27, 30, 33, 35, 36, 40, 44, 45, 46, 48, 50, 54, 55, 59, 60, 63, 66, 70, 72, 77, 80, 81, 84, 88, 90, 96, 99, 100, 108, 110, 117, 120, 121, 126, 130, 132, 135, 140, 143, 144, 150, 153, 154, 156, 160, 162, 165, 168, 170, 176, 180, 187, 192, 198, 204, 216, 240, 264

The skat: pick up and discard, or Hand

The declarer **picks up the skat** and **discards** any two cards face down; their points count for the declarer. Or they play **Hand** and leave the skat untouched – one level more, and only then may they announce Schneider or Schwarz. A suit game or Grand Ouvert is Hand only too; Null Ouvert may also follow a pick-up. Then they name the game. Forehand leads.

Games and game value

Game value = base value × multiplier. The multiplier is: matadors **with** or **without** so many (from ♣B down, counted over hand and skat) + 1 for **game** + 1 each for **Hand**, **Schneider**, **Schneider announced**, **Schwarz**, **Schwarz announced** and **Ouvert**. The base values:

Game	Diamonds ♦	Hearts ♥	Spades ♠	Clubs ♣	Grand
Base value	9	10	11	12	24

Null is not multiplied: the declarer must take no trick, at fixed values:

Game	Null	Null Hand	Null Ouvert	Null Ouvert Hand
Value	23	35	46	59

Winning and scoring

The declarer needs **61 card points** (skat included); 60 each is a loss. **Schneider**: one side has 30 points or fewer. **Schwarz**: one side takes no trick.

Won: **+ game value**. Lost: **− 2 × game value**. The defenders score nothing.

Overbid: if the game is worth less than the bid, it is lost and scored at the lowest multiple of the base value that reaches the bid.